

BROKE, CONFUSED & TRYING

◆ MINDSHIFT BOOKS



MindShift
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BROKE, CONFUSED & TRYING

A Practical Guide to Turning
Your Goals Into Reality



REAL GOALS. CLEAR PLANS. LASTING CHANGE.

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PREFACE

The Formula Myth

Most people have goals. Very few know how to turn them into reality.

A fantasy is just a goal without a deadline. But when you add a deadline, a plan, and action, you stop wishing and start executing. And when the goal is personal — actually yours, not inherited from someone else's expectations — the process becomes more meaningful, because you're no longer chasing someone else's definition of success.

This book is not another motivational read telling you to believe in yourself harder. It's a formula, applied ten different ways, to ten situations every Nigerian student or young adult already recognises — JAMB, hustle culture, NYSC, relationships, japa, broke months, family pressure, and the comparison trap.

Each chapter follows the same shape: a situation you already know, the formula applied to it, a real example, and one thing to actually do before you turn the page. No worksheets. No fluff. Just the formula, over and over, until it's the way you think.

CHAPTER 1

The Fantasy Trap

Why “One Day” Is Not A Plan

IN THIS CHAPTER

- Why “I go blow one day” is not a goal
- The exact difference between a fantasy and an objective
- How one missing ingredient — a deadline — decides everything

“I go blow one day.” Nigerian anthem. No deadline attached. No plan attached. Just vibes and faith.

You’ve said it. Your guy has said it. Everybody on WhatsApp status has said it — right under a screenshot of a private jet or a Burna Boy lyric.

Here’s the tea: a fantasy is just a goal that never grew up. It sounds like ambition. It functions like a daydream, because nothing about it can actually be missed, failed, or checked — and anything that cannot be failed was never really attempted in the first place.

THE FORMULA	WHAT IT MEANS
FANTASY = goal, no deadline	“I’ll be successful one day” — a wish with good PR.
OBJECTIVE = goal + deadline	“I’ll register my business by December” — now it’s real. Now it can disappoint you. That’s the point.

A PATTERN WORTH RECOGNISING

Tolu vs. Aisha. Tolu: “I want to start my skincare brand one day.”
Aisha: “I’m launching my skincare brand by August 15.” Guess who’s still saying “one day” next year.

“Your dreams have a WiFi password. It’s called ‘deadline.’”

YOUR MOVE

Write down one thing you’ve been calling a goal for over a year. Give it an exact date — not a season, not “soon,” an actual date. Notice how different it feels the moment it becomes missable.

CHAPTER 2

Senior Man Syndrome

What Hustle Culture Doesn't Show You

IN THIS CHAPTER

- Why hustle culture sells a highlight reel, not a blueprint
- What actually separates the flex from the plan
- Why attention is not a strategy

Every hostel has one. The guy with AirPods, a car key he “forgot at home,” and a business he’ll “explain later.”

Meanwhile you're eating garri and doing assignment, wondering when your own “senior man arc” dey come.

Here's the tea: hustle culture sold you a highlight reel and called it a blueprint. What you're seeing is the output, edited. What you're not seeing is the plan behind it — because unglamorous plans don't get reposted.

THE FORMULA	WHAT IT MEANS
THE FLEX = car, chain, 'loading'	Zero deadline, zero plan, all packaging.
THE PLAN = 1 skill + 1 client + daily action	Boring. Unfilmable. Actually gets you there.

A PATTERN WORTH RECOGNISING

Chidi vs. Ngozi. Chidi followed 40 “hustle gurus” on Twitter. Zero income. Ngozi followed 2 people, but spent 1 hour a day learning graphic design. First client by month 3. Attention is not a strategy.

“Comparison is the fastest way to fund someone else's highlight reel with your own peace.”

YOUR MOVE

List three accounts you compare yourself to most. For each, write down what you can actually see — and what you definitely can't. Unfollow one this week if it's not adding anything but pressure.

CHAPTER 3

JAMB Brain vs Life Brain

Why School Doesn't Prepare You For This Part

IN THIS CHAPTER

- Why exam-mode thinking breaks down after graduation
- The difference between finding an answer and building one
- Why life doesn't shade the correct option for you

You crammed past questions till 2am, scored your dream JAMB score, chanted “Unilag or nothing.”

Then real life happened — and it didn't come with an answer key.

Here's the tea: school trained you to find the one correct answer. Life needs you to build your own, from scratch, with no invigilator and no time's-up bell.

THE FORMULA	WHAT IT MEANS
JAMB BRAIN = 1 exam, 1 shot	Memorize, dump, forget. Someone else already knows the right answer — you just find it.
LIFE BRAIN = goal + deadline + plan, repeated	No invigilator, no bell. Just you and your own consistency.

A PATTERN WORTH RECOGNISING

Kelechi's freeze. *Kelechi crammed for JAMB and scored 320. First semester of uni, no one handed him a syllabus for “what to do with your life” — and he froze. That formula doesn't come from a textbook.*

***“Life doesn't shade the correct answer for you.
You have to build it yourself.”***

YOUR MOVE

Name one area of your life right now where you're still waiting for someone to hand you the “correct answer.” Write the smallest first move you could make without it.

CHAPTER 4

The NYSC Question Mark

What Comes After The Uniform

IN THIS CHAPTER

- Why a certificate is not a plan
- The one goal to set before your service year ends
- What separates corps members who drift from those who don't

You survive 4 (or 5, or 6) years. Camp comes. Everyone's dancing to the anthem.

Then it hits you: the real question was never “will I graduate.” It's “what am I even doing after this.”

Here's the tea: NYSC gives you a uniform. It doesn't give you a plan.

THE FORMULA	WHAT IT MEANS
THE QUESTION MARK = no next goal	“Let's see what happens” energy. Graduation with nothing loading behind it.
THE NEXT OBJECTIVE = 1 skill/path + deadline before POP	You leave camp with something already loading — not just a certificate.

A PATTERN WORTH RECOGNISING

Same PPA, different year. Two corps members, same PPA. One drifted through service year. One used it to quietly build a portfolio on the side. Guess who had options at POP.

“A certificate tells people where you've been. A plan tells you where you're going.”

YOUR MOVE

If your service year (or this semester) ended tomorrow, what's the one thing you'd wish you had already started? Set a deadline for starting it — this week, not “soon.”

CHAPTER 5

Situationship vs Ambition

When ‘Just Vibing’ Is Actually A Delay Tactic

IN THIS CHAPTER

- Why some relationships are fantasies too
- The formula test for a partner who builds with you
- What “just vibing” is actually costing you

“We’re just vibing” has delayed more dreams than any economy ever did.

Here’s the tea: some relationships are fantasies too — goals with no deadline, dressed up as love.

THE FORMULA	WHAT IT MEANS
SITUATIONSHIP = undefined + unlimited time	No deadline. Comfortable distraction dressed as love.
A REAL PARTNERSHIP = shared goals + mutual deadlines	Someone adding to your formula, not stalling it.

A PATTERN WORTH RECOGNISING

Blessing’s two years. *Blessing spent two years “figuring things out” with someone who never figured anything out. Meanwhile her business idea sat in her notes app, untouched.*

“If it has no deadline and no plan, it might just be a fantasy with someone else's name on it.”

YOUR MOVE

Be honest: is there a relationship in your life right now with no defined direction, no real deadline, and no shared plan? Write what it would look like to name that clearly — to yourself first.

CHAPTER 6

Japa or Stay?

The Same Formula, Either Direction

IN THIS CHAPTER

- Why japa is a goal like any other, not a vibe
- The four-part formula for any big life decision
- Why the same formula works whether you're staying or going

Every group chat has the japa debate. Half the country planning an exit, other half building where they stand.

Here's the tea: japa isn't a vibe. It's a goal like any other — and it needs the same formula.

THE FORMULA	WHAT IT MEANS
THE ESCAPE FANTASY = 'abroad will fix it'	No plan, no deadline. Just hope wearing a boarding pass.
THE ACTUAL DECISION = goal + deadline + plan + action	Same formula whether you're staying or going.

A PATTERN WORTH RECOGNISING

Two friends, one word. Two friends both said “I want to japa.” One is still saying it three years later. The other researched routes, picked a deadline, saved consistently. She's abroad now — not because she got lucky. Because she had a plan.

***“Wherever you're going — abroad or up the road
— the formula doesn't change.”***

YOUR MOVE

Whichever side of the japa debate you're on, write your goal, your deadline, your plan, and the one action you can take this week. No vibes — specifics.

CHAPTER 7

Broke But Building

Capital Was Never The Real Blocker

IN THIS CHAPTER

- Why capital was never the real blocker
- What “broke plus a plan” actually looks like
- The smallest possible first step with zero capital

Broke is not a personality. But a lot of us wear it like one — “no cap, no capital, no chance.”

Here's the tea: you don't need capital to start the formula. You need a deadline.

THE FORMULA	WHAT IT MEANS
BROKE + NO PLAN = waiting for miracle alert	Stuck. Hoping something lands in the account.
BROKE + PLAN = small goal + deadline + 1 skill + action	The beginning of every business you've ever admired.

A PATTERN WORTH RECOGNISING

Emeka's phone-only hustle. *Emeka started a social media management side hustle with just his phone and zero capital — one goal (first client), one deadline (by month 2), no fancy funding required.*

“You don't need capital to start the formula. You need a deadline.”

YOUR MOVE

Write one skill you already have that someone would pay for. Set a deadline for your first client, gig, or sale — with zero capital spent between now and then.

Parental Pressure vs Personal Dream

Whose Deadline Are You Actually Living On

IN THIS CHAPTER

- The difference between an inherited goal and a personal one
- Why achievement without meaning still feels like failure
- How to find the goal that's actually yours

“Become a doctor / lawyer / engineer” vs. the thing you actually want to do — the oldest Nigerian household argument.

Here's the tea: an achievement with someone else's fingerprints on it is still just a borrowed fantasy.

THE FORMULA	WHAT IT MEANS
INHERITED GOAL = someone else's deadline & plan	It can still work — but it rarely feels like yours.
PERSONAL GOAL = your deadline + your plan	This is Fulfillment — not just achievement, meaning.

A PATTERN WORTH RECOGNISING

Feyi's quiet page. Feyi studied accounting to please her parents and graduated top of her class — and felt nothing. Meanwhile she ran a small fashion page on the side: her own goal, her own deadline, her own plan.

“An achievement with someone else's fingerprints on it is still just a fantasy — theirs, not yours.”

YOUR MOVE

Write down one goal you're currently chasing because someone else expects it. Then write down one goal that's actually, fully yours. What would it take to give the second one even 30 minutes a week?

The Social Media Comparison Trap

You're Not Behind, You're Watching The Wrong Stage

IN THIS CHAPTER

- Why you're comparing your rough draft to someone's final cut
- What a highlight reel is actually hiding
- How to measure your own timeline instead of theirs

Everyone's "blowing." Everyone except you. Or so the timeline says.

Here's the tea: you're not behind. You're comparing your rough draft to someone else's final cut.

THE FORMULA	WHAT IT MEANS
THE HIGHLIGHT REEL = their success, no process shown	Posted with none of the deadline, plan, or grind behind it.
YOUR OWN TIMELINE = your goal + your deadline	Measured against you. Not them.

A PATTERN WORTH RECOGNISING

Dara's almost-quit. Dara compared her "still building" phase to a stranger's "just launched" post and nearly quit. She didn't know that stranger's launch took two quiet years.

“You're not behind. You're just watching someone else's final stage and calling it their first.”

YOUR MOVE

Think of the last post that made you feel behind. Write down what you don't actually know about that person's timeline. Then write down one thing on your own timeline you're quietly proud of.

CHAPTER 10

From Fantasy to Fulfillment

The Whole Ladder, One More Time

IN THIS CHAPTER

- The full five-stage formula, one more time
- Why the goal that changes your life is the personal one
- Your very next move, starting today

You've seen the formula applied to JAMB, jopa, situationships, broke months, and parental pressure.

Here's the whole ladder, one more time — all five stages, stacked.

THE FORMULA	WHAT IT MEANS
FANTASY = goal, no deadline	Just a dream.
OBJECTIVE = goal + deadline	A clearer target.
INTENTION = goal + deadline + plan	A real plan.
SUCCESS = goal + deadline + plan + action	Plans turned into results.
FULFILLMENT = personal goal + deadline + plan + action	A more meaningful life.

A PATTERN WORTH RECOGNISING

Your move. *Pick one fantasy sitting in your head right now. Give it a deadline before you close this book. That's it. That's the whole first step.*

“Now you know the formula. What are you going to do with it?”

YOUR MOVE

Choose one fantasy from your own life. Write it as a full Fulfillment statement: your goal, your deadline, your plan, and the one action you'll take today.

FINAL WORDS

What You Do With It Now

You now know the formula. Fantasy, objective, intention, success, fulfillment — goal, deadline, plan, action, and, when it's personal, meaning.

It won't feel dramatic the first time you use it. Giving one dream a deadline today doesn't feel like much. But that's how every version of you that actually finished something got started — not with more motivation, but with one fantasy that finally got a date attached to it.

Pick one. Start today.

“Now you know the formula. What are you going to do with it?”

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